

VALEN LI

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EDUCATION

AI + Finance @ UPenn's Jerome Fischer M&T Program (Class of 2030) Philadelphia, PA
Julia R. Masterman High School Philadelphia, PA
*GPA: 4.52/4.0 — Dual Enrollment: **Discrete Mathematics**, STAT 0001* Sep 2018 – June 2026
Robotics Team (Co-Founder & Lead Programmer) | Chess Team (Co-Captain) | AI Club (President)

EXPERIENCE

Amazon San Jose, California
Incoming AWS Software Engineer Jun 2027 – August 2027

Embedder (YC S25) San Francisco, California
Incoming Software Engineer Jun 2026 – August 2026

Wharton's Stevens Center for Innovation in Finance Philadelphia, PA
Full-Stack App Developer Jun 2024 – Jun 2025

- Enhanced key features of a student loan application to accurately project college costs, using PostgreSQL for data management and Spring Boot for API development
- Created a responsive [website](#) for the Finiverse project, and created web features for a data visualization platform.

Research Remote
Applied Machine Learning Jun 2024 – August 2025

- Carnegie Mellon University: Used Self-Adapting Language Models (SEAL) for improving email phishing filters.
- University of Washington: Built a ML pipeline system to classify COVID-19 variants from Single Molecule Break Junction (SMBJ) conductance signatures; achieved up to 99.97% accuracy.

PROJECTS

[LearnAI](#) | *Computer Vision, Javascript, GSAP* Feb 2024 – May 2024

- Awarded **\$2,500** at a Hack-a-thon by creating a website redefining AI education with
- Built from scratch utilizing GSAP and Lenis for animations and smooth-scrolling also mimicking features from Apple's website.

[Micro Pantry Mobile App](#) | *Computer Vision, React-native, Gen AI* April 2024 – Dec 2025

- Awarded **\$6,000** at a startup competition for creating an app using Expo, React, and React-native as the frontend
- Implemented Tensorflow, specifically ICR, receipt, and food detection models

[Real-time Edge Derivative Instance Segmentation](#) | *Python, OpenCV, PyTorch, YOLOv8* May 2025

- Built a more accurate real-time instance segmentation pipeline using edge derivatives, YOLOv8, and COCO labels

Other Projects | *Web Development, Chrome Extensions, Mathematical Modeling* 2024 – 2025

Root2Success	SMBJ ML Pipeline (UWash)	Math Modeling Analysis
APUSH Website	Merck Analysis & MVP	LockedIn Extension
FRC Robotics '25	FTC Robotics '23	FTC Robotics '24

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Java, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, TypeScript, Python, LaTeX
Frameworks/Libraries: Pandas, React, TensorFlow, OpenCV, Tailwind, Matplotlib, GSAP, Spring Boot
Skills: Web/App Dev, Data Science, Machine Learning, Computer Vision, Analysis

AWARDS

Genesis Fund x WndrCo Poker Tournament Winner March 2026
Won as the only high schooler | Beat out 50 MIT/Harvard Students & 10+ Quants

Chess: Earned >\$5,000 | Top 30 on Lichess UltraBullet | 4th @ World Open 2018 - Present
1st Place (\$5,000) - Innovation League 2024 October 2024
2nd Place (\$2,500) - Ctrl+Shift 2024 May 2024
1st Place- AMC 12B 2024 & 2025 | Certificate of Distinction and AIME Qualifier Nov 2024
3rd Place- Penn Mathematics Contest April 2025
Amazon Future Engineer Winner (\$40,000) April 2026